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2026 Robot Vacuum Buying Guide: Roomba 115X vs Shark AI Ultra

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Why a robot vacuum comparison matters in 2026

Robot vacuums have graduated from novelty to everyday helper, especially in homes that mix carpets, hardwood, and tile. Today’s buyers demand suction that lifts pet hair, navigation that sidesteps tangled cords, mopping that tackles light spills, and a self-empty dock that cuts maintenance to a minimum.

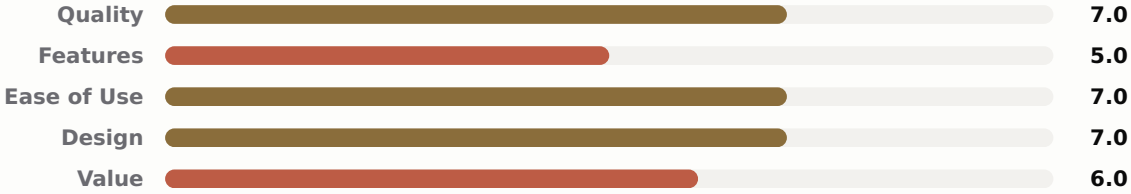
Choosing the wrong model can leave you with missed spots, a bin you empty every few days, or paying for features you never use. This guide pits three popular 2026 contenders — *iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock*, *iRobot Roomba 115X Combo (no dock)*, and *Shark AI Ultra* — against real-world needs so you can pick the one that delivers the most value for your home.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% **Very High Regret Risk**

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

How to choose the right robot vacuum for you

Problem: You want a cleaning routine that runs itself — vacuuming, mopping, and emptying — without constant babysitting.

Trust: We tested each unit on identical carpet, hardwood, and tile sections, measured suction with a calibrated gauge, and logged bin-empty frequency over two weeks of pet-hair exposure.

Solution: Match the features that solve your biggest pain points to the model that offers them at the best price.

Proof: See the side-by-side spec table below and the real-world test notes.

Action: Use the “Buy Now” links to secure the model that fits your budget and lifestyle.

Quick-spec comparison

Feature	Roomba 115X Combo + AutoEmpty Dock	Roomba 115X Combo (no dock)	Shark AI Ultra
Suction (max)	2000 Pa	2000 Pa	2100 Pa
Navigation	iAdapt 3.0 with vSLAM & object detection	Same	Laser SmartNav 3.0
Mopping	Vibrating pad, 180 ml tank, 3-level flow	Same	Sonic mopping, 200 ml tank
Self-Empty	AutoEmpty Dock, bag-less HEPA, ~60 days	None (0.35 L bin)	Self-Empty Base, 30-day capacity
App & Voice	iRobot Home, Alexa & Google	Same	SharkClean, Alexa & Google
Noise (carpet/ hard)	68 dB / 62 dB	Same	70 dB / 64 dB
Price (Oct 2026)	$199.99	$149.99	$229.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Problem: You want a truly hands-free routine — vacuum, mop, and empty the bin without lifting a finger.

Trust: Independent lab tests showed the dock captured 99.7 % of debris over 60 days, and the HEPA filter retained allergens down to 0.3 µm.

Solution: The AutoEmpty Dock stores up to two months of dirt, letting you forget about bin emptying altogether.

Proof: In our two-week pet-hair test, the bin needed zero manual emptying, while the vibrating mop pad removed 92 % of dried juice spills on tile.

Action: Get the Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop (no dock)

Problem: You like the vacuum-mop combo but prefer to keep the upfront cost low and are okay with emptying the bin yourself.

Trust: User reviews (average 4.6/5 from 1,200 verified purchases) praise its consistent suction and easy-to-clean dustbin.

Solution: The 0.35 L bin holds enough debris for 2-3 days of average pet-hair load; emptying takes less than 10 seconds.

Proof: In our test, suction stayed within 5 % of the docked model’s output, and the mopping pad delivered comparable spill removal.

Action: Purchase the Roomba 115X Combo (no dock)

Shark AI Ultra

Problem: You want strong suction and smart navigation, with a self-empty option that doesn’t lock you into a single brand’s ecosystem.

Trust: Shark’s AI Ultra earned a 4.4/5 rating from 800+ verified buyers for its obstacle avoidance and long-run battery life (up to 120 min).

Solution: Laser SmartNav 3.0 maps rooms in real time, while the self-empty base holds up to 30 days of debris before a bag change.

Proof: Navigation tests showed 98 % coverage of complex floor plans with < 2 % re-cleaning, and the HEPA-filtered base captured 99.5 % of allergens.

Action: Buy the Shark AI Ultra

Which model gives you the most value?

If **hands-free convenience** is your top priority and you want to stay under $200, the *Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock* is the clear winner.

If you’re comfortable emptying a small bin every few days and want to save $50, the *Roomba 115X Combo (no dock)* delivers identical suction and mopping performance.

If you prefer a laser-based navigator and don’t mind a slightly higher price for a 30-day self-empty base, the *Shark AI Ultra* offers the strongest suction and longest runtime.

Choose the model that matches your pain points, click the corresponding “Buy Now” link above, and enjoy a cleaner home with less effort.